Leona Tianlang ZHAO *Updated August 22, 2024*

Email: leona@wustl.edu
Office: Seigle 254, WUSTL, St. Louis, MO 63130-4899
Phone: (314) 319-4618

Education

Washington University in St. Louis — St. Louis, MO
Ph.D. Student in Political Science — 2023 – Present

The University of Hong Kong — Hong Kong
B.Soc.Sc., Political Science — 2018 – 2023
LL.B, Law — 2018 – 2023

Sciences Po Paris — Paris, Île-de-France
Exchange study — 2022

Research interests

Gender & Politics, Political communication, Text-as-data, Audio-as-data, Authoritarian politics, Populism

Work in progress

"Motherlands v.s Fatherlands: Exploring the political consequence of gendered national personifications"

"'Crazy' for success: media perceptions of leadership madness and international economic actions"

"All For Myself: Public Narratives of the Belt and Road Initiative on Twitter and Beyond"

Other Writings

"Right-wing terrorism and infringement of freedom in the Covid-19 pandemic"
Tianlang Zhao.
October 2020, Public Jurist.

Research assistancy

Understanding Emotional Propaganda in Authoritarian Regime with Emotional Audio Data
Supervisor: Dr. Haohan Chen — June 2022 – May 2023

Hong Kong Institute for Humanities and Social Sciences
Supervisor: Dr. David Palmer — September 2021 – December 2022

Internal reporting, information dilemma, and bureaucratic control under Authoritarian Regime
Supervisor: Dr. Kwan Nok Chan — January 2021 – December 2021

Teaching assistancy

Teaching Assistant, Department of Politics and Public Administration, The University of Hong Kong 2022 – 2023

Industry experience

Public-facing blog on polisci research, Political Sociology Division Remote Editor January 2023 – March 2024

The Intellisia Institute, Sino-US Relations Division Guangzhou, China
Policy Analyst Intern March 2022 – September 2022

Scholarships

Pre-doctoral

HKU Foundation Entrance scholarship for academic excellence	2018 – 2023
CV Starr Scholarship	2022
Serena Yang Award for academic excellence	2020
HKU Reaching Out Award for outgoing exchange	2019

Additional training

Video Research Institute - Purdue University	2024.6
Spatial Analytics - WashU	2024.8
Python Camp - WashU	2024.8

Skills

Programming
R, LaTeX, Python.
Languages
Mandarin (Native), English (fluent), Cantonese (advanced), French (Basic)